BEYOND POTENTIAL

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The Guide Nobody Gave You — Until Now

Patane Joshua V.

I dedicate this to God, myself, my parents,
and of course to that young person
who ever felt they were running behind in life.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU READ

In all my years on earth, I have discovered that most people find it very difficult to read. In simple terms — if you want to hide something from a Black man, put it in a book.

That saying is the idea behind keeping this book short, yet packed with everything you need to start moving towards greatness and wealth.

It does not have to be a thousand pages to influence change. What matters is the content — and whether you act on it.

This book is for you if you are a young person who wants more: more money, more impact, more freedom. By the time you reach the last page, you will have a direction. That is the promise.

INTRODUCTION

The 30-Year Problem

Nobody sat me down at sixteen and told me how money worked. Nobody explained networks, skills, or leverage. Nobody warned me that the decisions I made in my early years would either cost me a decade or save me one. I had to figure it out the hard way — and it took longer than it should have. This book exists so it does not take you that long.

It takes the average person thirty years to figure out life, and that is mostly because of a lack of knowledge and exposure.

In reality, there is only a slight difference between the hardworking man in the village and the man in the office in Lagos. The fact that one does not earn like the other does not mean he is lazy — it is the exposure and the smart application of effort that set them apart.

Since the problem is exposure, the earlier the better. If you get exposed early enough, you will get it right early enough.

It is a good sign that most parents today are concerned about their children's education. But it is a sad reality that most schools only teach you *what* to think — not *how* to build a life. There is a big difference between the two.

> ***"What took me ten years of trial, failure, and exposure — you are about to get in under two hours. Pay attention."***

CHAPTER ONE

Nobody Warned Me

At sixteen, I made a decision that changed everything — not because it was the right decision, but because it was the only one I was brave enough to make. I left home. And from that moment, everything I know about money, skills, and survival was learned the hard way: on the street, with no manual and no mentor. This is that story.

I left home after senior secondary school to retake my failed WAEC examinations, and that is how it all started. I wrote those same exams three times before I finally passed in 2018 — you can guess my age from that.

That is not the purpose of this book. While all of that was happening, I was trying different things — Graphic Design, Website Design, Digital Marketing, and more. Let me walk you through it.

Graphic Design (2016)

In 2016, I taught myself graphic design on my phone using PixelLab. It took me only one month to reach a confident level, because I was hungry — I explored every single tool in that app. I took my first job designing a business card and charged ten thousand naira for fifty copies. Printing only cost me two thousand naira, leaving eight thousand naira profit. That was a win.

Blogging (2017)

I needed to level up again, driven by that same hunger. In 2017, I was in Lagos with a friend — both of us taking an IJMB diploma course as a route into direct university entry. I discovered that my friend was a blogger and knew a bit about HTML. If you know how hungry I was, you

already know what happened next.

I became so addicted to blogging that even without a laptop, I would go to Redemption Camp at Mowe-Ibafo to buy time at a nearby ICT cafe. Thirty minutes cost one hundred naira, and my entire monthly allowance from home was five thousand naira. I built my first blog on Blogger.com, posted almost every day, and waited patiently for a Google AdSense approval.

Full Graphic Design and Digital Marketing (2018)

By 2018, I had levelled up to Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, and CorelDraw — now with my first laptop. I also completed a Digital Marketing course and became competent with Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok Ads.

University and the First Real Client (2019)

I gained admission to university around 2019 to study Agricultural Extension — yes, that is right. Around that time, I landed my first website design gig from two guys in Benin, Edo State. They asked a direct question: "How much do you charge to design a website?" As someone who had no direct mentor and had learned everything online, I replied, "Twenty-five thousand naira for one blog site, so two is fifty thousand."

I did not realise I had undersold myself until they agreed instantly. I started the job, ran out of money after paying for the domain and hosting, and had to go back to the client for more funds. They sent an extra ten thousand naira — just enough to finish the job, with nothing left over for me. First big lesson in pricing.

Hard Times

Hard times hit, and I ended up carrying blocks and cement at construction sites near my school just to survive my first year. The money I was making was no longer enough — and this was the same me who

had been surviving on a five-thousand-naira monthly allowance. I even made my first one hundred thousand naira that year, and it still was not enough. I ended up working daily at a cybercafe for five hundred naira a day.

Then a friend of mine — who is today a multimillionaire — called one day and asked for my account number. Someone in his hostel had given him a generous cash gift, and as a good friend, he thought to share with me. My first questions were immediate: How did you get this? What does that person do? How old are they? The answer shook me. Someone my age was already building his first house and controlling millions effortlessly.

That night was a lot to process — from thinking to imagining what path could give me the kind of life I actually wanted, because in that moment my desire shifted completely. It rose higher than I had ever imagined before.

Now I wanted more, but I had no idea how to start or where to begin. Every skill I had learned was being consumed by local friends who would pay one thousand naira for graphics and still would not come back consistently.

ooumart — My First Business (200 Level)

In my second year, I launched my first ever business — ooumart, a buying and selling platform for students at my school. It ran for a while before I shut it down. No profit in the first six months, and I kept spending more than I was making.

That closure would become my biggest regret once I eventually understood something critical: great business people do not quit easily. Every lasting business has a season of investment — uncomfortable, with no visible returns — and a season of harvest, where the investor is

rewarded for enduring the hard times. I quit just before harvest, and I have never forgotten that lesson.

> ***Morale: Never quit something with great long-term potential just because you cannot handle the short-term pressure.***

The Web3 Turning Point

A school friend, just one year ahead of me, was allegedly worth over one million dollars. It sounded impossible. I would never have believed such money was accessible to someone my age — those figures belonged to people like Elon Musk, Larry Page, or Jeff Bezos. Then I watched him buy his first car worth over fifty million naira and build a mansion for his parents. I did the rough calculation in my head. The numbers checked out. He had made all of this from Web3.

What shifted in my head was not the money itself. It was the person. He was my friend. He was proof that young people could make it big. From that moment, there were no more excuses.

That same night, I picked up my phone, created an X (Twitter) account, completed the full setup, and started doing what the people in that space were doing. Within the first three months, I made solid four-figure earnings in dollars. Today I keep growing and doing even more.

> ***"I did not need a rich family. I did not need a scholarship. All I needed was one person — one real person — who proved that it was possible. The moment I had that, the excuses ran out. They will run out for you too."***

CHAPTER TWO

The Mind Is the First Battlefield

Your biggest enemy right now is not poverty. It is not your environment, your family, or your lack of connections. It is the six inches between your ears — and what you have been quietly telling yourself is and is not possible. Everything else in this book is useless until you fix that.

If you continue to believe something is impossible, there is no way you can achieve it. You have limited yourself to a particular range, and you will not break out of it until you shift how you think. This is the primary reason why so many people stay stuck in life.

If my friend had never made that kind of money, I probably would have thought it was fantasy and settled for making two hundred thousand naira, calling it a great achievement. With that mentality, I could never have competed with anyone at a serious level.

Every time I have the opportunity to address people in public, I say the same thing: whatever you can imagine, you can achieve. That is not just motivation — that is how life actually works. Imagine it, then bring it to life.

Sick but true — I once had a conversation with a stranger in Ijebu-Ode who told me he could not do anything online because he felt his brain could not process it. He had already built a wall around himself. Even if someone had handed him the knowledge, he would have found a reason it would not work for him. I have met many people with the same mentality. Only a few are willing to change — sometimes because of their background, sometimes simply because they have become too comfortable with where they are.

Meanwhile, a few years ago, Asherkine made a video about his future and was extremely optimistic — not because he had a wealthy background or had it all figured out, but because he had a positive mindset and genuinely believed he would get there. What took him to that place years later was a winning mindset combined with consistency and focus.

From my personal experience, I have identified four major mindset shifts that I call **GET-B**.

G — Get a Mentor

This might be the single most important starting point. There needs to be someone who serves as the driving force behind your hunger for greatness. It could be a successful friend, an influential figure you follow online, or a schoolmate who has made it — just like my friend was for me.

If you do not have one yet, that is your assignment right now. Start going out. Meet people. Engage with them. See what they are doing. It will sharpen your appetite for better things in life.

You do not even need their direct mentorship. Sometimes all you need is to observe closely and replicate what worked for them. If they did it, you can do it — and most likely even more.

E — Erase Negativity

Even after seeing proof that success is possible, certain voices will still find reasons why it cannot be you. "He has rich parents." "He had connections." "You are not like him." These are the quiet thoughts that keep people average.

Erase negativity completely — from the people around you and from inside your own head. Not just the loud, obvious discouragement, but the

small, quiet kind too. "Are you not ashamed to start at your age?" "As big as you are, do you want to do TikTok Live?" Those subtle whispers are the ones that quietly kill dreams. The most successful people are those who care least about what others think.

Steps to break free:

— **Unfollow** negative friends and relatives. Stop sharing your plans with them. This is not hatred; it is protection.

— **Distance yourself.** When you are physically close to people, you talk more and absorb their energy. Create space intentionally.

— **Replace.** Find at least one person with a positive mindset to share your ideas with. Someone who tells you to go for it.

T — Think Beyond

Think so big that it scares you. Think to the point where you ask yourself, "How is this even possible?" — and then work towards it anyway. Be relentless about your vision.

> ***"If your dream does not scare you, you are not dreaming big enough."***

If something were truly impossible, you would not be able to imagine it in the first place. And if someone else has already done it, there is no reason that person cannot be you.

B — Build Around Positivity

This is the stage where you deliberately surround yourself with people who believe in what you are building — people who push you, challenge you, and refuse to let you settle. Find motivation around you and build from within.

Who you spend time with is not a soft topic. It is a life-or-death career decision. You could spend your entire life falling short simply because of the wrong people you chose to keep around you. If a circle is not working for you, change it immediately and do not apologise for it.

Sogunro had two friends he had been close to for about five years. One day, he told them he was interested in starting a podcast — he had realised he had a gift for conversation. His friends shot the idea down immediately. Where would he even get a tripod? A microphone setup? They discouraged him until he woke up one day, packed his things, and left.

He moved to a new city and started his life over. Today, Sogunro is a successful podcaster and those same friends now celebrate him. But if he had stayed and listened to them, he would still be in that same room with his potential locked inside.

Life is a personal journey. You are not living it to satisfy anyone else's expectations. Every successful person you admire made that same decision at some point — to choose their future over other people's opinions.

Answer these questions honestly before moving on:

— What are your dreams in life?

— Have you shared them with the people around you?

— What was their response?

— Do your friends encourage your ideas or quietly let them die?

If you can answer those questions without lying to yourself, you already know what to do next.

> ***"You cannot afford the wrong circle. Not at this stage. Not when everything is still being built. The people sitting next to you right now are either your greatest asset or your most expensive liability. Only you know which one."***

Three wealth principles to carry with you:

1. **Eliminate distraction.** Poverty feeds on inattention. The more distracted you are, the longer you stay stuck in survival mode.
2. **Embrace boring discipline.** Poor people often want fast results. They chase new opportunities without achieving depth or mastery in anything.
3. **Learn how to sell like your life depends on it.** You can be the best at what you do, but if you cannot sell or present your value, you will stay broke.

CHAPTER THREE

Know What You're Made Of

Most people choose a career the same way they choose what to watch on Netflix — based on what is trending, what their friend picked, or what looks good from the outside. Three years later, they are burnt out, broke, and starting all over again. This chapter exists to stop that from happening to you.

I assume you are ready for the biggest change in your life. But before we talk about paths, let us talk about you. Do you actually know what you are made of, or are you chasing something because you saw it online or because someone else made money from it?

A lot of people have wasted years by choosing the wrong direction — one that was trending at the time, or one their friend was winning from. I once called a school friend who seemed lost. He had been trying to make money through internet fraud for years, and all his late nights and effort had produced was between fifty and two hundred dollars — never once a significant breakthrough. Meanwhile, this same person had learned fashion design and could have built something substantial from it. After a long conversation, I encouraged him to go back to his craft and invest in his personal brand. Today, he is a fast-growing fashion designer in Lagos.

You have real potential. You are skilled and talented. Do not let those gifts go to waste chasing something that was never really meant for you.

This is where you need to understand the difference between **passion**, **talent**, and **market demand**. These three combined have produced the most successful people in the world.

Earlier this year, I started a school-to-school outreach programme talking about Web3 and digital skills. Friends started calling to ask why I was doing it. My answer was simple: *passion*. The only thing that sustains continuous action is passion. When you genuinely enjoy something, you do it repeatedly without being forced.

Talent is what you can do naturally that not everyone else can replicate. You are gifted at it, and passionate about it at the same time. For example, Promise could sit down at a keyboard piano and effortlessly move everyone in the room.

Then there is market demand — what people actually want and are willing to pay for. The artists in Lagos love variety, but most had only one keyboardist producing one familiar sound. If you can create multiple melodies and beats, they want exactly what you are offering.

> ***"Passion, talent, and market demand — align all three and you have the foundation for everything."***

Find Your Type

Most people overcomplicate self-discovery. You simply need to understand how you naturally win. Read the five types below and pick the one that fits you best.

1. The Builder — You bring ideas to life

You enjoy creating things from scratch. You get satisfaction from completing a project. You think in systems, tools, and products. You hate talking about things without actually building them.

Your strengths: execution, creation, problem-solving.
Your path: coding, product development, design, operations.

Ask yourself: Do you enjoy solving problems? Have you ever looked at a broken situation and immediately started thinking about how to fix it? If you are a Builder, you are the person who cannot just talk about an idea — you have to go and make the thing. That restlessness is not a flaw; it is the most valuable trait in the digital economy right now.

2. The Communicator — You turn ideas into clarity

You explain things better than most people. You enjoy writing, teaching, and storytelling. People often tell you that you made something easy to understand. You naturally simplify complex ideas.

Your strengths: clarity, persuasion, storytelling.
Your path: content creation, copywriting, teaching, marketing.

I have seen secondary school students write brilliantly — constructing stories that people genuinely connect with. Do you enjoy writing? Do you express yourself naturally through words? If so, brands are actively looking for people who can communicate ideas. Put yourself out there.

3. The Performer — You capture attention effortlessly

You enjoy being seen or heard. You are expressive and energetic. You naturally entertain or engage people around you. You are confident on camera or in front of a crowd.

Your strengths: presence, energy, influence.
Your path: video content, public speaking, entertainment, personal branding.

Ask yourself: Are you comfortable in front of a camera? Do you enjoy debates? Are you energised by people's attention? Bank on your strengths. Do things that make you visible. **If you are not findable, you are not fundable.**

4. The Analyzer — You see what others miss

You question everything. You love data, patterns, and strategy. You prefer thinking before acting. You spot flaws quickly.

Your strengths: strategy, logic, decision-making.
Your path: trading, research, strategy roles, systems optimisation.

Can you identify the exact error in a complex document others overlooked? Have you ever listened to a story and found yourself thinking several layers deeper than everyone else in the room? Build on this. Reach out to projects that are struggling. Develop sharp, repeatable strategies.

5. The Connector — You open doors others cannot

You build relationships easily. You always know the right person to reach in any situation. People trust you quickly. You enjoy bringing people and opportunities together.

Your strengths: networking, collaboration, influence.
Your path: community building, partnerships, sales, leadership.

Yhemolee once said the most money he ever made in Lagos came from connecting one person to another. As a Connector, you are a valuable asset to privately owned brands, companies, and organisations — whether connecting them to an angel investor, a potential client, or the right partner.

Pick the type that describes you best. Then remember this:

— Builders need Communicators

— Communicators need Analyzers

— Performers need Builders

— Everyone needs Connectors

You do not need to be everything. You just need to dominate your lane and pair with people who complement where you are weak.

"You are not behind. You are not too late. You just did not know which direction to run in. Now you do. The next chapter will show you exactly where that direction leads."

CHAPTER FOUR

Pick Your Lane

I am going to save you five years with this chapter. Five years that most people spend chasing the wrong path, burning out, and starting over with nothing to show for it. By the time you finish reading this, you will know exactly which of the three wealth paths was built for someone like you — and why the other two will drain you if you force them.

There are only three real ways people build wealth: **Career**, **Entrepreneur**, and **Hybrid**. Each one works, but each one demands a different type of person.

1. The Career Path

This is for people who thrive in structured roles — nine-to-five jobs, shift-based work, corporate environments. You follow an already-built system and prove your value within a defined position. Career workers earn predictable income: salary and bonuses.

The simple formula: **Stability** → **Growth** → **Promotion** → **Higher Pay**

Best suited for: Analyzers, Communicators in corporate or management roles, and Builders in engineering or development.

Realistic timeline:

— **Short-term (3–6 months):** Steady income begins

— **Mid-term (2–5 years):** Career growth and promotions

— **Long-term (10+ years):** Real wealth — only if properly invested

Hidden risks: your income is capped by someone else's decision, job security is never fully guaranteed, comfort can stop your growth, and you are always trading your time directly for money.

2. The Entrepreneur Path

Here, you build something from nothing — with no guaranteed income, constant problem-solving, and multiple hats to wear at once. Your life moves through a cycle: **Chaos** → **Learning** → **Failure** → **Breakthrough**.

Best suited for: Builders who love creating, Performers who are strong at brand-building, and Connectors who are skilled at partnerships and growth.

Realistic timeline:

— **Short-term (0–12 months):** The struggle phase — usually little to no pay

— **Mid-term (2–5 years):** Traction begins

— **Long-term (5–10+ years):** Real wealth

Hidden risks: years of hard work with no payoff, deeply unpredictable income, serious risk of burnout, and most businesses fail quietly without anyone noticing.

3. The Hybrid Path — The Smart Play Right Now

This is where things get interesting, especially for young Africans. The Hybrid Path means combining a stable income source — a job, freelance work, or gigs — with scalable digital assets at the same time.

A typical hybrid day looks like this:

— **Morning:** client work, freelance project, or job

— **Afternoon:** skill-building

— **Evening:** content creation, personal brand, side income

The movement: **Income** → **Skill** → **Audience** → **Leverage** → **Freedom**

Best suited for: Communicators (content, writing, storytelling), Builders (freelancing, design, development), and Connectors (community building, growth, deals).

Realistic timeline:

— **Short-term (1–3 months):** First income online

— **Mid-term (6–18 months):** Consistent income stream

— **Long-term (2–5 years):** Real independence

Hidden risks: it is essentially two lives at once, which can be exhausting; easy to get distracted chasing every new thing; demands strong self-discipline; and the early results are slow — which is exactly when most people quit.

> ***"Mark Angel started making videos with no money and virtually no viewers. Today, he is one of the top earners on YouTube. The years of posting with little visible result pay off — eventually."***

Why the Hybrid Path Is Most Relevant for You

Let us be honest about the reality in Nigeria. Jobs are limited. Salaries are often low relative to the real cost of living. But opportunities are now global, thanks to the internet. The smartest move is to stop depending on a single income stream.

The Hybrid Formula — broken into clear steps:

1. **Learn a high-income skill.** Pick one: design, copywriting, video editing, YouTube automation, web development, or social media management.
2. **Monetise it quickly through freelancing.** Offer services on X, WhatsApp, or LinkedIn. Work with global clients. Earn in stronger currencies — dollar and euro preferred.
3. **Build a personal brand.** Share your journey. Teach what you are learning. Show your results publicly.
4. **Turn attention into assets.** Digital products, courses, communities, an agency — these are natural next steps once you have an audience and a reputation.

The first thing I tell every student I work with: document everything online. Post your process, your results, your wins, and even your struggles. The internet is vast and people are always watching. One day, the right person will find you.

To wrap this chapter — you will burn out if you jump into entrepreneurship too early, stay in a job too long, or start the hybrid path without real discipline. Know when to commit and when to pivot. If something is genuinely not working after a fair attempt, it is okay to stop and try a different direction.

Write down your answers to these questions right now, before you turn the page:

— Do I want stability first?

— Do I want risk with a bigger upside?

— Do I want control and flexibility?

"There is no wrong answer — only an honest one and a dishonest one. The honest answer is the one that matches who you actually are, not who you want to be seen as. Start from truth. Everything builds from there."

CHAPTER FIVE

The Skills That Actually Pay

Somewhere right now, a twenty-two-year-old in Lagos is making three thousand dollars a month from a skill he learned in ninety days — on YouTube, for free. No degree. No connections. No startup capital. Just one skill, taken seriously and marketed correctly. This chapter is the list. Your job is to pick one and never look back.

Ninety percent of young people do not want a nine-to-five, which puts most of us on the Hybrid Path. So let us talk about the skills that actually work, and how you start and grow fast on this lane.

From my story in Chapter One, I tried at least eight different skills before finding what worked for me. It may not be the same one for you — but after Chapters Three and Four, you already have a strong sense of which direction fits your type.

Section A: Tech Skills

Tech skills range from the straightforward to the highly complex, but even the simpler ones require strategy if you want to earn from them seriously.

Web Design

Web designers focus on the visual side of websites — typically working with platforms like WordPress and Shopify, using templates to build sites and landing pages. Little to no coding is required.

As simple as that sounds, a sharp web designer can earn between **one million and three million naira per month**, depending on client volume and personal branding. My last e-commerce project — a

multi-vendor site — earned me five hundred thousand naira and was completed in under three days.

UI/UX Design

UI (User Interface) is about how a product looks; UX (User Experience) is about how it feels and functions. This is more advanced than basic web design — think building fully custom interfaces from scratch in Figma.

Earnings: **$500 to $1,500** per landing page for small businesses; **$3,000 to $10,000** for a full corporate site. In Nigeria, consistent work can yield five to eight million naira annually depending on your positioning.

Learn for free: Google UX Design Certificate via Coursera, Webflow University, and the Figma YouTube Channel.

Web Development

Developers build websites from the ground up using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Working remotely for a US-based company, a mid-level developer earns between **$2,000 and $4,000 per month**. It is a massive field, so use structured roadmaps to avoid getting overwhelmed.

Learn for free: The Odin Project (full-stack, project-based, open-source), freeCodeCamp (interactive lessons with certifications), and MDN Web Docs (the definitive reference for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript).

Mobile App Development

A student once asked me if she could build gaming apps — and I did not limit her, because that might well be her path. At entry level, expect to earn around **$75,000 to $100,000 per year**. At mid-level, that rises to **$130,000 to $180,000**. As a freelancer, you can charge around **$180 per hour**.

First decide between native development (Swift for iOS, Kotlin for Android) or cross-platform (React Native or Flutter). Learn for free: CS193P by Stanford University, Google's Android Basics, and Expo Documentation.

Section B: Content Creation

Content creation may look crowded since everyone from teenagers to grandparents now uses TikTok, Facebook, and Instagram. But it is still very possible to break through — and it is not limited to making videos.

Video Content

If you can package ideas into video, this lane is yours. Something happens on your street last night — you film a short clip, make it relatable, and people connect. That is the whole formula. Consistency and relatability.

Written Content

Written content demands that you observe your chosen niche closely and breathe life into your writing. The best writers make readers feel like they were inside the scene, not just reading about it.

How do you earn? Almost every major platform now pays for views and impressions:

— **X (Twitter):** approximately $400 per two million impressions, paid fortnightly. Creators also get paid directly by brands for promotional posts. If a post earns $1,000 and still generates one hundred thousand impressions, X pays you on top of that fee.

— **YouTube and TikTok:** approximately $1,000 per two million views, plus brand deals and sponsorships once you have an audience.

— **Instagram:** also monetised, with its own payment structure.

Platform eligibility to start earning:

— **X (Twitter):** 5 million impressions, 500 verified followers, Premium subscription active.

— **YouTube:** 4,000 watch hours in 12 months (or 10 million Shorts views in 90 days), 1,000 subscribers, and community guidelines compliance.

Use TikTok and Instagram to promote your YouTube content. Use YouTube for depth, short-form platforms for reach. Most content creators post full videos on YouTube and drive traffic with clips on TikTok. That system works.

Section C: High-Value Soft Skills

Sales, copywriting, communication, and networking sound basic to most people. They are not. Every serious company needs someone who can convert. If you can talk people into buying things, you are in high demand — across every industry.

Copywriting is not random writing. Everyone can write, but not everyone is a copywriter. If you can move people through words — professionally, persuasively, and with precision — you belong here.

> ***"Someone with average tech skills and great sales ability will always out-earn someone with great tech skills and poor sales ability."***

These soft skills multiply everything else. They are the difference between a deeply talented person who remains invisible and a moderately skilled person who builds an empire.

Section D: Videography with Your Phone

Most of us are walking around with a professional-grade camera in our pockets and using it mostly for selfies.

The first time I featured in one of Dezny's comedy videos, we were at Olumo Rock in Abeokuta. We had no dedicated camera — only iPhones. The quality was beyond what anyone expected. No viewer ever asked whether it was shot on a phone or a digital camera. Most popular comedians today shoot their content entirely on mobile phones.

Last month, I attended a major Web3 event and watched a guy cover the entire thing with his iPhone 16 Pro. It looked personal at first — until I realised it was too thorough and systematic for that. He was on a paid gig worth over a thousand dollars, including editing.

A woman on TikTok I know earns an average of **one million naira every month** by editing pictures on her phone. People send her raw photos; she sends back transformed results. That is her entire business.

Good with video on your phone? Start by reaching out to friends. Offer free services initially and post every result on social media to build a visible portfolio. There are no limits to what a focused phone in the right hands can produce.

Bonus: Two Skills Nobody Talks About Enough

AI Prompting

People are losing jobs right now — not because they are incompetent, but because they are AI-illiterate. The flip side is that people who know how to use AI are earning faster and producing more than ever before.

I can prompt an AI agent to build a professional website in five minutes. The quality of the output depends entirely on the quality of the instructions. That is the skill — knowing how to direct AI with precision to

get results others cannot replicate.

Last year, I made an average of **fifteen million naira using AI-assisted work**: designing graphics for projects, writing articles, building tokenomics documents and budgets for Web3 clients, and more. AI was the multiplier; prompting was the skill that unlocked it.

Learn for free: DeepLearning.AI (prompt engineering course by Andrew Ng), OpenAI and Anthropic's official documentation, and LearnPrompting.org (open-source, beginner to advanced).

YouTube Automation / Faceless YouTube

AI has made it possible to earn from YouTube without ever showing your face. This involves content strategy, SEO, and using tools to streamline video production entirely. You run the channel; AI handles the heavy lifting.

Learn: **CreatorOps AI** at creatorops.site (niche finder, script generator, SEO-optimised titles — I recommend this one personally), Think Media on YouTube, YouTube Creator Academy, and HubSpot Academy.

Stop reading right now. Write down the one skill from this chapter you are committing to. Not two. Not three. Just one. You can come back to the rest later. Without that one commitment, this chapter means nothing.

> ***"The skill is not the hard part. Starting is not even the hard part. The hard part is staying when it gets boring — and it will get boring before it gets profitable. The people who push through that boring middle period are the ones who end up with the life everyone else is watching from the outside."***

CHAPTER SIX

Network Is Net Worth

I once got paid more than my friend thought I was worth — by fifteen times — without negotiating, without a portfolio presentation, without a single sales call. The client looked at my profile, saw what I stood for, and paid exactly what I asked. That is not luck. That is what personal branding does. And it is available to you right now, for free, starting today.

Skills alone do not pay the bills. Positioning and relationships do.

You have probably seen someone and thought, "This person is so intelligent and talented" — yet they are struggling financially, while someone far less skilled is thriving. There are two reasons for this. First: being talented is different from actively doing something with that talent. This world rewards action more than expertise. Second: networking is usually the missing piece. Talented people stay invisible because they have not built the relationships that would make them visible to the right people.

I have had a client come to me from the comfort of my own house because a friend had already vouched for my work, my skills, and even my pricing — before I said a single word. We closed the deal without any stress. That is what a strong network does for you.

How to Approach a Mentor Without Being Desperate

The begging-for-a-follow-back approach has never worked for anyone. Sliding into someone's DMs with "please check DM, follow back" only inflates their ego. Here is a smarter, step-by-step approach:

1. **Follow them** on the platform where they are most active. Show up where they can see you.
2. **Turn on their notifications** and engage immediately. Be among the first to respond when they post. In the first seconds after something goes live, the creator is still on their device and will see the top comments.
3. **Leave thoughtful comments** — not generic statements, but responses that trigger a reply. Make your insight impossible to scroll past.
4. **Stay consistent** until they notice you. This may take weeks. Keep showing up.
5. **Make sure your own page is active and meaningful.** When they check who has been engaging them, your profile is your first impression. What will they find?
6. **Once they follow back or respond,** send a direct message. This is now a warm conversation, not a cold approach.
7. **In your message,** acknowledge their work genuinely, share a relevant idea, and ask a specific question. Be brief and purposeful.

This is where your personal brand does the work for you. If you have been building consistently, your profile speaks before you do.

Personal Branding

On X, I am known as a creator, educator, and developer in the Web3 space. Because of that positioning, projects reach out to me regularly — paying me to educate their communities or to make posts about their work. My identity in that space does the marketing for me.

Early in 2026, a project contacted me about a promotional post. My follower count was below five thousand. A friend suggested I quote them twenty-five dollars. I quoted **fifteen times that amount**, then waited a week without following up. They paid in full, without any negotiation.

> ***"Start building your name today. What do people think of when they hear it? Work backwards from that answer. People do not buy products — they buy individuals."***

Networking vs. Relationship Building

Many people have attended events specifically to "network" and walked away with nothing but a few phone numbers that never went anywhere. That is because collecting contacts is not the same as building relationships.

Relationship building is a skill in itself. It requires creating genuine value for others — solving a real problem, sharing something useful, showing up consistently. When people know you can help them, they naturally want to keep you close and refer others to you.

Here is a simple example: you meet someone at an event, mention that you are a trader, and genuinely grow their money by one hundred dollars in the first week. You now have a real relationship. They will hold onto you and refer you without being asked. Value creates loyalty.

Key Secrets of Networking

— Hard work will pay your bills. Smart work will make you a millionaire. But hard work, smart work, *and* networking together will make you a billionaire.

— When you are in a room where serious people are discussing business and you have something valuable to contribute, you have

already begun your ascent.

— **Bonus insight:** If a wealthy person gives you money, they have given you the least of what they had to offer. The one thing you should always ask from a wealthy person is *access* — access to relationships, rooms, and conversations. That is where real wealth transfers.

According to **Dr. Cosmas Maduka**, there are six levels of money, and cash is the last and least of them:

1. **Credibility** — what you build through consistent, verifiable actions over time.
2. **Credible Relationships** — when someone of credibility avails their name and standing on your behalf.
3. **Integrity** — doing the right thing even when no one is watching. Dr. Maduka described this as one of the scarcest commodities in Nigeria.
4. **Character** — the foundation of any person's life and the bedrock of leadership.
5. **Competence** — being genuinely skilled at what you claim to do. This is why mentorship matters.
6. **Cash** — the level everyone understands, and the least powerful of all six.

Anyone who has cash without those five foundations has most likely not earned it through value. Money is an exchange for value. If the value was not delivered, the money was not truly earned.

Your Social Media Is a Career Tool

Be honest with yourself: are you actually earning from your social media, or are you just consuming? Does your TikTok make money or just pass time? Does your LinkedIn profile look like someone who is intentional about life? Can someone read your X profile and walk away with something useful?

Your online presence is always on. People are always watching, even when you think nobody is paying attention.

Practical steps to take this week:

— Clean up your X, LinkedIn, TikTok, and Instagram profiles.

— Post something valuable that reflects your skills or interests.

— Follow leading accounts in your chosen niche.

— Turn on their notifications and engage with quality, thoughtful comments.

— Send a purposeful direct message using the mentor approach above.

"Your name is either working for you right now or doing nothing. There is no middle ground online. Every day you are not building it, someone else in your space is. Start today. Post something. Say something. Be findable. The right people are already looking — they just cannot find you yet."

CHAPTER SEVEN

Living Beyond Your Potential

I almost quit. Not once — multiple times. I almost quit when ooumart was bleeding money and nobody was buying. I almost quit when I was charging one thousand naira for designs that should have been worth ten times that, and still getting ignored. I almost quit when everyone around me seemed to be moving forward while I was standing in the same place — skills, effort, and all — going nowhere. This chapter is for the version of you that is about to quit. **Don't.**

There is a pattern that almost nobody talks about, and it destroys more careers than any lack of talent ever could. Most people give up within the first three months of trying something new. Here is exactly how it unfolds:

— **Weeks 1–3:** Pure motivation. You post daily, learn fast, and everything feels possible.

— **Weeks 4–6:** Reality sets in. Results are slower than expected. Growth is inconsistent. Things are not moving the way you imagined.

— **Weeks 7–9:** Silence. No big wins, no validation, nothing visibly working.

This is when most people quit. I have been there. It was almost at this exact point that I gave up on ooumart in my second year — not because I was incapable, but because I expected results faster than reality allows.

> ***"The first three months do not count. You are just building momentum."***

Hold that thought alone, and you will outlast ninety percent of the people who started alongside you. Life does not care about potential — it

rewards the ones who step forward first.

Motivation vs. Discipline

When you started reading this book, you probably felt motivated and eager to begin. But motivation is not reliable — it is a feeling. It rises and falls with your mood, your energy, and your environment. If you rely on motivation alone, you will be inconsistent.

Discipline is different. **Discipline is a system.** It means showing up even when you do not feel like it, following a routine automatically, and removing the daily decision of whether or not to act.

For me personally — nobody reminds me to wake up at 5am. Nobody tells me to log on to X and post. Nobody forces me to build something new. These things have become part of who I am. I have built systems around them, and now I genuinely enjoy doing them.

Build a system and protect it:

— One hour daily working on your brand — non-negotiable

— One post per day on social media — non-negotiable

— One meaningful new connection every day — non-negotiable

Stand tall. Act like the universe owes you a seat at the table — and go take it.

Setting Targets That Stretch Without Breaking You

Most people fail here. They either aim too high, burn out, and quit — or aim too low and stagnate. The goal is to find the uncomfortable-but-doable zone.

Use the **70% rule**: if you can complete your goal seventy to eighty percent of the time, you have the right-sized target. Examples:

— Post five times a week instead of seven

— Work two focused hours daily instead of ten

— Reach out to ten potential clients instead of a hundred

These targets look modest. But they are actionable, sustainable, and far better than burning brightly for two weeks and disappearing. **Consistency beats intensity every single time.** You do not need to go hard for two weeks; you need to stay consistent for two years.

The Compound Effect

Real success does not come from big wins. It comes from small actions, repeated over time. People ignore this because the early results are invisible. There is no applause. No immediate reward.

But the mathematics are undeniable:

— One post a day is 365 pieces of content in a year

— One new connection a day is a powerful network in twelve months

— One new client a month is a full income stream in a year

Each of these actions looks insignificant alone. But stacked over time, they compound into something that looks, from the outside, like overnight success. It is not — it is simply delayed results. Your skills sharpen. Your network grows. Opportunities multiply. Then the doors open.

The only focus should be getting better at what you are doing. Fall in love with the journey. Before you know it, you will have achieved the big dream without the anxiety you imagined it would take.

What Living Beyond Your Potential Actually Means

A quick reminder: ninety percent of people who have lived and died never unlocked even ten percent of their potential. And ninety percent of people alive today are on the same path.

Your potential is simply what you are capable of — the gifts, skills, and capacity already inside you. Most people never reach it because they become comfortable. **Average people stop when it feels hard. People who grow keep going while it feels hard.**

> ***"If Otedola at his current net worth is still pursuing more, if Adeleke is still working hard, if Dangote is still actively monitoring his companies — what is your excuse for not craving greatness?"***

I have heard someone call themselves rich after making two hundred dollars. I am not diminishing that — it is real money. But you could make more if you simply did not stop. Even Oliver Twist asked for more. That hunger — the refusal to accept just enough — is what separates those who grow from those who plateau.

Greatness requires a consistent hunger for it. Think outside what you currently know. Envision yourself at a greater level. Then take one step in that direction. If your dream does not scare you, you are not ready for it yet.

Your 90-Day Action Framework

1. **Month 1:** Focus on your online presence. Build around your name, clean up your profiles, and post consistently. Personal branding is the foundation.

2. **Month 2:** Confirm that your network is compounding. By now, you should have eliminated negativity around you and replaced it with people who are actively building. You should be engaging mentors and making meaningful connections.
3. **Month 3:** Document and review your results. If you are a Builder, something should be actively working. If you are a Communicator, your audience should recognise your voice. Look back at where you started and write it down.

Follow through on the 90 days, then share your progress with me via my social handles or email: **patane.victory@gmail.com**

"Nobody is coming to rescue you. Nobody is going to hand you the life you deserve. But here is what I know for certain: the version of you that keeps going — even when there is no applause, no money, and no sign that it is working — that version wins. Every single time. Be that version."

CONCLUSION

The Only Person in Your Way

You just did something most people never do. You sat down with a book and you finished it. That already separates you from ninety percent of the people who will hear about this book, buy it, and never get past the first few pages. But finishing a book means nothing if you close it and go back to the exact same routine. So before you put this down, I need you to do one thing.

Write down one thing you are going to do differently starting tomorrow. Not a goal. Not a vision board. One action. One concrete, specific thing you will do tomorrow morning that you were not doing before you read this book. That is the whole assignment.

The three biggest enemies standing between you and the life you want:

1. **The Comfort Zone.** People become so comfortable with their current situation that they resist change — even when that change would clearly benefit them. Eighty percent of the population will find reasons not to move, even when the door is wide open.
2. **Learned Helplessness.** This is where people hand the economy, their upbringing, or their circumstances every excuse for why they cannot start. They think of reasons rather than solutions.
3. **The Path of Least Resistance.** Always looking for the easy way. But nothing truly worthwhile is easy. Everything worth having requires a long period of consistent effort, with many failures along the way.

Remember: it takes the average person thirty years to find what works for them. If you start now, you could be set by your early twenties.

You now have what most people will never get until it is too late — the exposure, the frameworks, the direction. Most people are addicted to consuming information but allergic to acting on it. You have been reading. Now go and execute.

From me to you — if you ever thought that greatness only comes from generational wealth or lucky circumstances, remember that someone had to build every great dynasty that exists. A legacy has to start somewhere. **Let it start with you.**

I wrote this book at an age when most people are still trying to figure out what they want. I am not done building — not even close. But I know this: the hunger I had at sixteen, the same hunger that sent me to a cybercafe with a one-hundred-naira time slot and no laptop of my own, is the same hunger that will take me wherever I am going next. You have that same hunger. I can tell — because you read this far. Now go and do something with it. **I am watching.**

— Patane Joshua V.

RESOURCES

Where to Learn — For Free

Every skill mentioned in this book can be learned without spending a single naira on courses. Here is your directory.

Website Design & UI/UX

· Google UX Design Certificate via Coursera — covers Figma, wireframing, and the full design process

· Webflow University — visual web design, layout theory, interactions without coding

· Figma YouTube Channel — "Best Practices" series, industry-standard tool tutorials

Web Development

· The Odin Project — full-stack, project-based, open-source curriculum

· freeCodeCamp — interactive lessons, certifications in web design and JavaScript

· MDN Web Docs — the definitive reference for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript

Mobile App Development

· CS193P — Stanford's iOS development course, free online

· Google's Android Basics — beginner Android development in Kotlin

· Expo Documentation — beginner-friendly React Native for iOS and Android

AI Prompting

· DeepLearning.AI — "ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers" by Andrew Ng

· OpenAI & Anthropic Documentation — official prompt engineering guides from the source

· LearnPrompting.org — open-source, beginner to advanced techniques

YouTube Automation & Content Strategy

· CreatorOps AI — creatorops.site (niche finder, script generator, SEO tools)

· Think Media on YouTube — gear, SEO, and data-driven growth strategy

· YouTube Creator Academy — how the algorithm works, analytics strategy

· HubSpot Academy — free courses in content marketing and social media strategy

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Patane Joshua V.

Patane Joshua V. is a developer, educator, content creator, and builder from Nigeria.

He graduated from Olabisi Onabanjo University with a 2.1 degree in Agricultural Extension — a reminder that where you start does not determine where you end up.

He is the founder of **Web3withLeu**, a grassroots outreach programme that visits secondary schools across Nigeria to introduce students to blockchain, digital skills, cryptocurrency, and remote work opportunities. The programme has reached over 1,200 students.

As a content creator on X (Twitter) under the handle **@leukocyteng1**, he holds a CoinMarketCap verified creator badge and actively educates his community on Web3, digital income, and strategy. He is also the founder of **CreatorOps AI** — an AI-powered toolkit designed to help creators on X and YouTube find their path and grow effectively.

Beyond Potential is his first book.

A FINAL ASK

If this book moved you, pushed you, or gave you a direction you did not have before — I would love to know about it.

Leave a review on X and tag me **@leukocyteng1**, or make a short video on TikTok talking about the book with the same tag. Your words will help this reach the next young person who needs it.

> ***"Tell a friend about Beyond Potential. That might be the push they have been waiting for."***

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